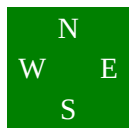


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2
♥ K 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3
♥ J 10
♦ Q 10 9
♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5
♥ A Q 6 3
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ K J 8

West	North	East	South
	1NT	2♠	3♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
either ♣s or ♠s. Unless a defender foolishly discards a ♥ it can't come from that suit. Which means you have to win a ♦ trick.

So after winning the ♠A, you play a ♣ to dummy's ♣K, then lead a small ♦ toward your hand and play . . . what?

At first this looks like the classic King / Jack guess situation where you try to figure out if East is more likely to have the Ace or the Queen.

But it isn't like that at all. If East has the ♦A then he will take it no matter which ♦ you play, and will defeat you with 1 ♦ and 5 ♠ tricks. Your **ONLY** chance to make this contract is for West to hold the ♦A. So you play the ♦K, then you . . .

. . .

Lucky you, West did have the ♦A.

Smart you, if you had played the ♦J you'd be down 2.

Partner's cue-bid is the lebensohl version of Stayman, in this case promising 4 ♥s. Since it is an immediate cue-bid it denies a ♠ stopper.

You are forced to bid and you don't have 4 ♥s.

But you **DO** have a ♠ stopper so you decide bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠K.

You hold up your ♠A until the third round; East started with 6 ♠s.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 4 :: Total = 8

You need just one more winner. It cannot come from ♥ it can't come from that suit. Which means you

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

You have an invitational strength hand with a 6-card Major suit. It's a no-brainer; you transfer with a 2♥ bid. Partner says 2♠;

You have an invitational strength hand with a 6-card Major suit. It's a no-brainer; you transfer with a 2♥ bid. Partner says 2♠;

Repeat: You have an **invitational** strength hand with a **6-card** Major suit. So you invite with 3♠s. Partner accepts with 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by West.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♥Q. Of course you take the ♥A.

Loser List: ♠ = 1/2/3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 ::
Total = 4/5/6

Missing 5 ♠s, the most likely split is 3-2, (68% of the time). You win the ♥A then play ♠K and ♠A, both defenders following to both leads but the ♠Q is still out there.

Do you play ♠s again or not?

Usually it is a good idea to leave a master trump un-pulled and go about your business winning tricks in other suits. The idea is to force them to ruff without using any more of your trumps. But that is only "usually". Here your big source of winners is going to be the ♣ suit - and there are zero outside entries to it. Suppose you do not force out the ♠Q, but start playing ♣ winners. A defender might ruff the third ♣ and you would be doomed.

So play one more ♠ and they are doomed.

Master trump outstanding: To pull or not to pull, that is the question.

Almost always the answer is "not to pull".

The big exception is when you have a running suit in one hand but with no outside entries to it. A hand exactly like this one.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 13

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2
♥ K 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3
♥ J 10
♦ Q 10 9
♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5
♥ A Q 6 3
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ K J 8

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 7 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 27

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

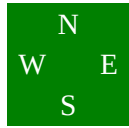
♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 31

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2
♥ K 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3
♥ J 10
♦ Q 10 9
♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5
♥ A Q 6 3
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ K J 8

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 33

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2
♥ K 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3
♥ J 10
♦ Q 10 9
♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5
♥ A Q 6 3
♦ 8 5 4 2
♣ K J 8

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 8 7 4 2
♦ A 7
♣ 10 6 5 3

♠ A 7 2

♥ K 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 7 2



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ J 10

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 3

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ K J 8

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 10 5

♣ 9 8 2

♠ Q 10 4

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ A J 7 3

♣ J 5



♠ K 5

♥ A 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A K Q 6 3

♠ J 9

♥ Q J 9 7 3

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 7 4